

Reflection Report

Event Title: "Regional ICT Summit and Exhibitions (RISE) Cordillera"

I. Details of the Event/Activity

The Regional ICT Summit and Exhibitions (RISE) Cordillera was held on November 28, 2024, at Plaza Lodge in Baguio City. The event aimed to promote ICT development in the Cordillera Administrative Region and establish the area as a potential ICT hub.

The summit brought together diverse stakeholders including government officials, industry leaders, ICT professionals, and educators. Key focus areas included digital transformation initiatives, IT-BPM sector growth, and regional investment opportunities. The event featured presentations, exhibitions showcasing local ICT innovations, and networking sessions designed to foster collaboration among participants.

II. Key Learning Outcomes and Insights

The summit highlighted several critical aspects of regional ICT development. Talent development emerged as a primary concern, with discussions emphasizing the need to align educational programs with industry demands, particularly in the IT-BPM sector. There's a significant skills gap between current educational outputs and market requirements that needs addressing.

Infrastructure challenges were extensively discussed, focusing on how geographical constraints in mountainous regions create unique obstacles for broadband deployment and digital connectivity. However, these challenges also present opportunities for innovative solutions like satellite connectivity and distributed computing models.

The event explored ICT's potential for economic inclusion, demonstrating how digital technologies can bridge urban-rural economic disparities. Importantly, discussions raised questions about ensuring ICT development strategies serve genuine local community needs rather than simply replicating urban-centric models.

Investment attraction strategies were analyzed, exploring how Cordillera can differentiate itself from established ICT hubs through unique value propositions such as cultural diversity, environmental advantages, and cost competitiveness.

III. Practical Applications and Implementation

The insights can be applied across multiple levels. Educational institutions could strengthen partnerships with government and private sectors to create comprehensive ICT training programs that address skills gaps while incorporating local cultural competencies.

Government units could implement e-governance initiatives that improve public service delivery, particularly beneficial for geographically dispersed communities where physical access to services is challenging. Digital transformation strategies discussed could inform policy development for investment attraction and infrastructure improvement.

Private sector applications include developing targeted strategies that highlight regional advantages while addressing infrastructure concerns. Community-level implementation should ensure ICT development genuinely serves local needs and incorporates traditional governance structures and cultural values.

IV. Event Organization Assessment

The summit was well-organized and professionally executed. The venue at Plaza Lodge provided an appropriate setting for the scale and objectives of the event. The multi-sectoral participant mix created valuable networking opportunities and facilitated comprehensive discussions from various perspectives.

The exhibition components effectively showcased local innovations and provided tangible examples of successful ICT implementations. The balance between presentations, exhibitions, and networking sessions maintained participant engagement throughout the event.

V. Recommendations for Future Events

Several enhancements could improve future summits:

Extended Format: Consider multi-day events or hybrid online-offline formats to accommodate remote participants from across the region's dispersed communities.

Follow-up Mechanisms: Establish online platforms or forums to maintain post-event collaboration and implement discussed initiatives.

Community Integration: Include more grassroots community representatives to ensure development strategies align with local needs and cultural values.

Practical Workshops: Add hands-on technical sessions alongside presentations to provide concrete skill-building opportunities.

VI. Supporting Documentation



Blog link: <https://jayvee-blog-practicum2.vercel.app/>